# Business Plan Template · Expert version

A business plan template gives you a proven structure for describing your business, market, strategy, operations and finances, so you can raise money, align partners or simply think clearly about where the business is going.

## How to use this template

1. Start with the Financials tab: rough numbers early show whether the idea works.
2. Work through each section on the Business plan tab, writing short, specific answers.
3. Write the executive summary last, once everything else is clear.
4. Assign an owner to each section if several people are contributing, and use the Status column to track progress.
5. Ask someone outside the business to read it and challenge your assumptions.
6. Export to PDF or copy the answers into a formatted document when you share it with investors or lenders.

## Tips

• Keep the plan short: investors often read only the summary and financials.
• Back up market claims with sources and realistic numbers.
• Show the assumptions behind every projection.
• Update the plan at least once a year or when strategy changes.

## Dashboard (sample data)

| Field | Value | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Owner | Founder | 1 |
| Status | Not started | 12 |
| Status | In progress | 0 |
| Status | On hold | 0 |
| Status | Blocked | 0 |
| Status | Done | 0 |

## Business plan · Work through each section and track progress

| Section | What to cover | Your answer | Owner | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Executive summary | The business in one page: problem, solution, target customers, why now, financial headline and the ask. | | Founder | Not started |
| 2. Company description | Mission, legal structure, location, founders and stage of the business. | | | Not started |
| 3. Problem and solution | The customer problem, how you solve it and why your solution is better than alternatives. | | | Not started |
| 4. Market analysis | Target segments, market size (TAM/SAM/SOM), trends and customer needs. | | | Not started |
| 5. Competition | Direct and indirect competitors, their strengths and weaknesses, and your advantage. | | | Not started |
| 6. Products and services | What you sell, pricing, product roadmap and intellectual property. | | | Not started |
| 7. Marketing and sales | Positioning, channels, sales process, customer acquisition cost and retention. | | | Not started |
| 8. Operations | Suppliers, facilities, technology, key processes and milestones. | | | Not started |
| 9. Team and management | Founders, key hires, advisers and the organisation chart. | | | Not started |
| 10. Financial plan | Revenue model, 3-year projections, break-even point and key assumptions (see Financials tab). | | | Not started |
| 11. Funding request | How much you need, what it will be used for and the expected return for investors. | | | Not started |
| 12. Appendix | Supporting documents: CVs, market research, permits, contracts. | | | Not started |
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## Financials · Three-year profit and loss projection: edit the figures and totals recalculate

| Line item | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue | 120,000 | 210,000 | 340,000 | Units sold x average price |
| Cost of goods sold | 48,000 | 80,000 | 122,000 | |
| Gross profit | 72,000 | 130,000 | 218,000 | Calculated |
| Salaries | 60,000 | 95,000 | 140,000 | |
| Marketing | 15,000 | 25,000 | 35,000 | |
| Rent and utilities | 12,000 | 12,500 | 13,000 | |
| Other operating costs | 8,000 | 10,000 | 12,000 | |
| Operating profit | -23,000 | -12,500 | 18,000 | Calculated |
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